

Data Governance Policy

Meridian Industrial Group | Version 2.1

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Approved By:	J. Harmon, VP of Operations

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the principles, standards, and accountability structures governing data management across all Meridian Industrial Group operating divisions. It applies to all employees, contractors, and third-party partners who create, access, modify, store, or transmit organizational data in any format, whether digital or physical.

The scope encompasses all data assets including but not limited to: customer records, financial transactions, engineering specifications, supply chain data, human resources information, and operational telemetry collected from manufacturing systems.

2. Governing Principles

All data governance activities within Meridian Industrial Group shall be conducted in accordance with the following core principles:

- **Accountability:** Every data asset must have a designated owner responsible for its accuracy, security, and lifecycle management.
- **Transparency:** Data collection, processing, and sharing practices must be documented and accessible to authorized stakeholders.
- **Integrity:** Controls must be in place to prevent unauthorized modification, ensure traceability, and maintain audit trails for all data transformations.
- **Proportionality:** Data retention and access controls must be proportionate to the sensitivity and regulatory requirements of the data classification tier.
- **Interoperability:** Data standards and formats must support cross-divisional integration and alignment with industry frameworks including ISO 8000 and DAMA-DMBOK.

3. Data Classification Tiers

All organizational data shall be classified into one of four tiers based on sensitivity, regulatory exposure, and operational impact:

Tier	Classification	Examples	Access Control
1	Public	Marketing materials, press releases	Unrestricted
2	Internal	Operational reports, project plans	Role-based
3	Confidential	Financial data, HR records, contracts	Need-to-know
4	Restricted	Trade secrets, M&A data, security configs	Named individuals only

4. Roles and Responsibilities

The following roles carry specific data governance responsibilities within the organization:

4.1 Chief Data Officer (CDO)

Establishes enterprise data strategy, chairs the Data Governance Council, and reports quarterly to the Executive Committee on data quality metrics, compliance status, and risk posture. The CDO maintains final authority on classification disputes and cross-divisional data sharing agreements.

4.2 Data Stewards

Appointed at the division level, Data Stewards are responsible for implementing governance standards within their domain. They conduct monthly data quality reviews, manage access requests for Tier 3 and Tier 4 data, and serve as the primary point of contact for compliance audits within their area of responsibility.

4.3 All Employees

Every employee is responsible for handling data in accordance with its assigned classification tier, reporting suspected data breaches within 24 hours through the established incident response channel, and completing annual data governance training as coordinated by the Learning and Development division.

5. Compliance and Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or contract. The Data Governance Council will conduct annual compliance reviews and may initiate ad hoc audits based on reported incidents or regulatory changes. All enforcement actions will be documented in the governance audit log and retained for a minimum of seven years.